

THE INFORMATION PROCESS: SUMMARY

The Information Process is a simple but powerful 6 step method that can be applied to any research, in any subject area, at any level of education.

See also [Research Advice](#) documents on the SACE website.

In addition the TAFE site, [My information skills](#), provides information and online tutorials to develop information literacy skills and is particularly relevant for students doing TAFE courses.

STEPS IN THE PROCESS :

DEFINING

What do I really want to find out?

What is my purpose?

What do I need to find this out?

What are the key words and ideas of the task?

What do I need to do?

Brainstorm. Create focus questions: ask what? who? where? when? how? why?

LOCATING

Where can I find what I need?

What do I already know?

What do I still need to find out?

What sources and equipment can I use?

Consult dictionaries, encyclopaedias and other reference books to define more key words. (Try [Wordle](#) for help in defining key words.)

Search the library catalogue to locate books, vertical files etc.

Will other sources of information be useful? e.g. periodicals, newspapers (ANZ Reference Centre), Intranet data, Internet sites.

SELECTING

What information do I really need to use?

What information can I leave out?

How relevant is the information I have found?

How credible is the information I have found?

How will I record the information I need?

Use contents and indexes. (Keywords)

Scan relevant sections. (Keywords)

Select best resources.

NOTE. (See SMC Reference and note taking sheet)

Record: author, title, where published, publisher, date of publication for the bibliography. (See the SMC Bibliography Guide.)

Whilst using the Internet it is essential that you consider the reliability of the information presented. Check the Guide to assessing web pages.

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ORGANISING

How can I best use this information?

Have I enough information for my purpose?

Do I need to use all this information?

How can I best combine information from different sources?

Organise notes.

Plan assignment.

Do I need to search beyond SMC Resource Centre? (e.g. relevant organisations, individuals or other libraries.)

PRESENTING

How can I best present this information?

What will I do with this information?

With whom shall I share this information?

In consultation with your teacher, the information could be presented in a variety of forms, e.g. written, oral, power point.

** Use notes to compile the [bibliography](#).*

EVALUATING

What did I learn from this?

Did I fulfil my purpose?

How did I go with each step of the Information Process?

Could I have done things differently?